

Cooler Master Cosmos S

The New Cosmos – Now Lighter

Cooler Master has a new cabinet on their earlier case – the Cosmos. This new one is called the Cosmos S. The old Cosmos, like the Cooler Master Stacker set the standard for high-end enthusiast level cabinets. The new one seems to be an improvement over it. We look at what they've changed.

While unpacking the humongous box that it comes in, we noticed that it was a lot lighter than the previous one. It has a little more of an aggressive look but that's left to personal taste. It still has the similar design with the piping that runs along the top and bottom of the case. The side door of the case has a huge 230 mm fan. There are three other fans in the case – one on the top, back and front. A sliding dust filter



fits at the bottom where the power supply fan would normally be.

The quality is still there but it's not as great as the Stacker and the older Cosmos. The rear panels seem thinner and can be depressed by applying pressure. The side doors wobble

about little bit and the front bays are covered with a thin mesh instead of the clean glossy panels. Those too aren't very steady. The top too has a mesh which means frequent cleaning will be required.

The top front of the case has the I/O panel. Four USB ports, two sound ports, an eSATA and a Firewire port can be accessed. There are plenty of drives that can be put into this case. The punch-in mechanism makes it easy to remove and add drives.

The new Cosmos S is more like a standard Cosmos built to a budget. The updated look will grab a lot of attention but with enthusiast cases, it has to

also be about flawless quality. That's something the Cosmos S has lost in the bargain. It's more a concern because the price of this case is still very high at Rs 14,500.

Specifications

Seven 5.25-inch bays, Four 3.5-inch bays, seven expansion slots, 3 x 120 mm fans, 1 230mm fan, Dimensions: 266 x 598 x 628mm, Weight: 13.8 kg

Contact: Cooler Master
Phone: 9833870302
E-mail: Tanmay.L@Coolermaster.com
Web site: www.coolermaster.com
Price: Rs 14,500

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Canon PowerShot A1000 IS

PowerShot Loses Weight And Some Features



The camera is compact with a bulging right side where the batteries lie. The camera uses AA batteries so it is as expected a tad heavier than Lithium-ion powered cameras of the same size. The feel of body is okay but it is a rigid camera that can take a battering. The buttons are simple but firm and don't have the spongy-

soft feel you find in some camera.

The screen is pretty bad – the colours are dull and the viewing angles are very poor, so using it isn't all that much fun. There is also some delay which gets worse when

you zoom into a target.

The interface is clean and simple to use. Most of it is due to lack of some features. The camera doesn't have a shutter and aperture priority setting. Manual focus is absent too.

The area around the batteries gets warm but not as much as the SX 110 IS that we looked at this month.

The flash is mounted on the extreme top-left of the camera. If you have a habit of holding a camera at both ends, then you are bound to cover the flash at least a little bit.

Image quality isn't grainy as such, but the images aren't sharp either, even with the ISO option set to as slow as 80. The images have an artificial glow to them as well. When photos are taken against bright light, the light measuring doesn't work very well and you end up with a photo with extreme contrast levels. Summing up, image quality is average.

The Canon PowerShot A1000 IS is cheaper than the other Canon cameras from the PowerShot series at Rs 11,995. It's nothing impressive and the lack of

some advanced features means people who want to develop some photography skills are not going to enjoy using it. Users who want a simple point and shoot camera, click the odd photo might find it usable.

Specifications

10 MP sensor, 4x optical zoom, 2.5-inch screen, ISO Range: 80 to 1600
Dimensions: 95.4 x 62.4 x 31.0 mm, Weight: 155 g

Contact: Canon India Private Ltd
Phone: 1800-180-33-66
E-mail: info@canon.co.in
Web site: www.canon.co.in
Price: Rs 11,995

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Satguide GPS Logger

Tiny Tracker

Interest in GPS receivers and handheld devices has only picked up recently in India. Mobile phones with inbuilt GPS receivers are the reason for this interest. They are expensive and people without these phones have no scope of getting a GPS feature on their phone.

GPS receivers like the Satguide GPS Logger come to fulfil this requirement. The GPS Logger is a USB GPS receiver that fits into a battery pack which is used to power it. This device can be plugged into a laptop and be used as a GPS receiver. It can also be used as a Bluetooth GPS receiver which means you can connect your phone to it wirelessly.



The most important feature of the Satguide GPS Logger is its ability to store co-ordinates without even connecting to a PC, laptop or even a mobile phone. For this, the device requires to be connected to a PC or laptop and the options set for it. There are some customisations and

the frequency of recording co-ordinates. The software is very basic and not the simplest to use. Co-ordinates can be exported as CSV (comma separated values) or KML. KML is used widely by Google Earth and is good free complimenting software.

As for performance, the device works perfectly fine if put in a shirt pocket or on a dashboard of a vehicle. If the refresh rates and others settings haven't been loaded properly, then the accuracy reduces drastically.

The ability to store coordinates without any kind of computing power of a laptop or a cell phone is an excellent feature but not enough to justify a hefty price of Rs 7,000. For

people who want GPS tracking, then this is one of the few products to come across. If it's just a GPS receiver for your PC or phone, then a simple Bluetooth receiver can be bought for much less.

Specifications

SiRF Star III chipset, Class 2 Bluetooth, Dimensions: 72 x 21 x 13.5 mm (Dongle)

Contact: SatNav Technologies
Phone: 040-66777333
E-mail: satguide@satnavtech.com
Web site: www.satguide.in
Price: Rs 7,000

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Philips GoGear 5245

Flash PMP Sans Flair

This 4 GB PMP is slightly thicker than an iPod Touch and looks decent with a black glossy finish to it. It's a device with curved edges having the headphone and mini USB connections at the bottom. The buttons are placed on the right of the screen with volume controls on top of the device, so if you are holding it you can control the device with your thumb and the volume with your index finger.

The PMP is very easy to use and has uncomplicated menus and settings. There are 3 skins you can choose from to enhance your viewing pleasure. The earbuds supplied with the player have a decent sound quality. We noticed the bass was strong, but unfocused and the mid-range is largely recessed. A good set of head-



phones would increase the sound experience greatly.

The inbuilt FM radio can hold 20 preset channels. There is also a voice recorder feature. Files are saved in WAV.

A drawback we found in this player was that it does not support WAV, but when auto-sync is on, WAV music is added to the device, which causes the player to hang.

Video conversion and upload software is provided with the driver CD. The viewing screen is a 2.8-inch LCD with a glossy finish to it and the video resolution is QVGA

320x240. There is no change in the viewing angles of this player in comparison to any others: If the light is minimal and the player is close to you it won't make a difference, but if you are sitting next to a window, expect glare to interfere.

A good feature is that if you are watching a video or listening to a song and shut down the player midway, playback resumes from when you last stopped.

Another feature of this PMP is Bluetooth. You can now transfer songs, videos, pictures, etc via Bluetooth.

This device also supports A2DP. One thing to be cautious about this is that mono headsets will not work.

This device has nothing very outstanding about it, and is not really worth the Rs 8,499 price tag.

Specifications

Formats supported: MP3, WMA, AAC, WMV, MPEG4
Screen: 2.8inch QVGA 320x240 resolution.

Contact: Philips Electronics India Ltd.
Phone: 0124-4311111
E-mail: sanjeev.nimkar@philips.com
Web site: http://consumer.philips.com
Price: Rs 8,499

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★